They replied, ‘The Ghawā road is certainly in front; by it, people cross for Far-kat.’ They guided Babur further for that and together they went on till in the third watch of the night reaching the Karnān gully which comes down from Ghawā. Then Bābā Sairāmī said, ‘Stay here a little while, [till] I look along the Ghawā road.’ Babur waited along with another person. Soon he returned and said, ‘Some men have gone along that road, led by one wearing a Moghūl cap; there is no going that way.’

Babur was alarmed upon hearing these words. Dawn had broken, yet Babur lay in the middle of the cultivated land, far from the road which he wanted to take. Babur said to Bābā Sairāmī, ‘Guide me to where I can hide today, and tonight when you will have laid hands on something for the horses, lead me to cross the Khujand-water and along its further bank.’ The reply came as, ‘Over there, on the upland, there might be hiding.’

‘There is no doing without food for ourselves or our horses,’ Banda-’alī said, ‘Let me go into Karnān and bring what I can find.’ He was the commandant of Karnān.

They stopped a couple of miles before Karnān. Here, Banda-‘alī went off.

He had gone for long. The next dawn was nearing and there was no sign of him. Time crossed further. The bright day had broken and there he appeared, bringing three loaves of bread but no corn for the horses. Babur smiled looking at him and then they all put a loaf each into the breast of their tunic. They quickly went up the rise, tethering their horses in the open valley. They went to higher ground to keep watch.

Babur assumed that by midday, Aḥmad the Falconer would have gone along the Ghawā road for Akhsī. Babur thought of calling to him and saying, with promise and fair-minded word, ‘You take those horses,’ for they had had a day and a night’s strain and struggle, without corn, and were utterly done. But then again, Babur was a little uneasy as he didn’t trust him entirely. Babur conjectured that the two men whom Bābā Sairāmī had seen on the road, would be in Karnān that night. Babur decided that he would fetch one of the horses of Banda-‘alī and Bābā Sairāmī. And then each one would go his own way. Around mid-day, something glinting was seen on a horse, as far away as the eye would reach. Babur wasn’t sure what it was. Perhaps it was Muḥammad Bāqir Beg himself who had been with Babur in Akhsī. He was also with Babur when he along with his men had got out and scattered during the battle. Perhaps, he had come this way and had been moving to hide here and there.